MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第6回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第6回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To prevent flooding during autumn typhoons, city crews regularly ( ) fallen branches and silt from the canal.

1 exaggerate **2** excavate **3** evaporate **4** evaluate

(2) Although the new railway timetable looks complex on paper, transfers have become much more ( ) in practice.

1 fruitless **2** reckless **3** restless **4** seamless

(3) The botanical garden prohibits drones overhead lest their buzzing noise ( ) nesting herons along the pond.

1 agitate **2** allocate **3** alleviate **4** affiliate

(4) Many small bookbinders survive by serving a ( ) market of museums and collectors who need archival repairs.

1 numb **2** naive **3** niche **4** neat

(5) Because the two witnesses described the van's color differently, police sought camera footage to ( ) the facts.

1 contaminate **2** corroborate **3** congratulate **4** compensate

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) The mountain clinic operates on a tight budget, yet its nurses never (　　) on sterilization procedures.

1 compliment　**2** comprehend　**3** compromise　**4** comply

(7) Little (　　) the hikers suspect that the quiet valley stream had carved an underground cave just beneath their feet.

1 have　**2** had　**3** were　**4** did

(8) With construction cranes blocking the east lane, delivery vans were (　　) through the industrial park until noon.

1 diverted　**2** dissolved　**3** disguised　**4** disputed

(9) The ceramic mug's thick stoneware walls help (　　) the heat of brewed coffee on chilly mornings.

1 retrieve　**2** restrain　**3** resume　**4** retain

(10) All summer interns are required to sign an agreement pledging not to (　　) client records outside the office.

1 displace　**2** disclose　**3** dispose　**4** dissolve

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Although the island's population has shrunk, the autumn lantern festival remains as (　　) as it was fifty years ago.

1 vague　**2** vacant　**3** vibrant　**4** verbal

(12) The new tram fare will take (　　) on April 1, though commuter passes purchased in March remain valid at the old price.

1 effect　**2** effort　**3** account　**4** charge

(13) Before replanting an orchard, agronomists test the soil to determine which minerals have been (　　) over decades.

1 depicted　**2** depleted　**3** deployed　**4** deported

(14) Rather than buying bottled water every day, carrying a stainless flask pays (　　) within a single month.

1 off　**2** out　**3** back　**4** up

(15) The two coastal villages were connected only by ferry until a suspension bridge spanned the (　　) in 1998.

1 streak　**2** strain　**3** strand　**4** strait

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) Students submitting digital essays must name their files (　　) the format shown on the syllabus.

1 on the verge of　**2** for fear of　**3** in keeping with　**4** at the expense of

(17) The conductor praised the youth orchestra's (　　) to detail during the quiet woodwind passage.

1 attraction　**2** attention　**3** admission　**4** ambition

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Mountain Roads Curve Instead of Climbing Straight

Travelers winding slowly up a mountain pass through a dozen sharp switchbacks sometimes wish engineers had simply cut a straighter road up the slope. On a map, zigzags double the driving distance between the valley floor and the ridge. In steep terrain, however, curving back and forth is what keeps heavy vehicles moving safely in every season.

Physics sets strict limits on road steepness. Once a slope exceeds roughly eight to ten percent, loaded delivery trucks overheat climbing up and risk brake fade coming down, while winter ice turns steep straightaways into dangerous slides. Lengthening the horizontal path through switchbacks spreads the same vertical climb gently across more pavement. (18), ordinary buses and snowplows can serve highland villages year-round.

Curves also help roads survive heavy mountain rain. Water rushing down a long, straight incline gathers speed and gouges out asphalt edges. Switchbacks allow engineers to slant each short segment slightly into side ditches that release water harmlessly onto rocky ledges. (19), retaining walls stay lower and disturb less forest soil.

A winding pass may test a passenger's patience, yet its geometry proves that (20).

(18)

1 Nevertheless
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 As a consequence

(19)

1 Furthermore
2 Instead
3 Previously
4 Otherwise

(20)

1 heavy delivery trucks cannot drive on paved switchbacks
2 straight roads are always safer on icy winter slopes
3 working with slope physics creates safer, more durable mountain links than fighting gravity head-on
4 mountain villages have no need for snowplows in winter

How Salt Marshes Buffer Coastal Towns

For centuries, coastal planners viewed tidal salt marshes—flat expanses of mud and tough cordgrass flooded twice a day by the sea—as unproductive wasteland best drained for warehouses or ports. Only after severe storm surges battered concrete seawalls did engineers begin measuring how much quiet protection intact marshes had been providing for free.

When storm waves roll across shallow marsh grass, millions of flexible stems create friction that drains energy from the moving water. Wave-tank experiments and field sensors show that a healthy strip of salt marsh just a hundred meters wide can cut wave height by more than half before water reaches an inland dike. Unlike a rigid concrete wall, which cracks over decades and cannot grow taller as sea levels creep upward, marsh plants trap floating sediment around their roots after high tides. (21), a living marsh can gradually build its own elevation year by year if given room.

Restoring drained marshes requires careful choreography rather than simply knocking down old embankments overnight. If seawater floods subsided land too deeply all at once, cordgrass drowns instead of taking root. Coastal teams therefore open tidal gates gradually or spread clean river silt acquired from harbor dredging to raise the mudflat first. (22), oyster reefs placed along the seaward edge shield young grass seedlings until their roots knit the mud together.

Living shorelines rarely eliminate the need for inner levees in densely populated ports. Even so, pairing engineered dikes with restored marshes gives coastal cities (23).

(21)

1 On the contrary
2 In this way
3 Otherwise
4 Despite this

(22)

1 Otherwise
2 Nevertheless
3 Likewise
4 Previously

(23)

1 total protection without any planning or sediment management
2 a reason to demolish every inner levee in crowded ports
3 a way to turn seawater into dry warehouse floors
4 a layered, adaptable defense that strengthens over time

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Notice About Instrument Acclimatization for the Winter Concert

From: H. Kurosawa, Orchestra Stage Manager
To: String and Woodwind Players
Subject: Instrument delivery and humidity rules at Highland Hall

Dear musicians,
For Sunday's winter symphony concert at Highland Hall, temperatures outside are forecast to stay below freezing all morning, while the stage is heated to twenty-one degrees. Moving wooden string and woodwind instruments straight from icy car trunks onto a warm, sunlit stage can crack spruce soundboards or split clarinets within minutes.

To prevent thermal shock, please arrive through the loading dock by 10:30 a.m. and leave your instruments inside their closed cases in Acclimatization Room B for forty-five minutes before tuning. Staff have set humidifiers in Room B to forty-eight percent so cases warm up gradually.

Cellos and double basses traveling in our equipment van must be loaded at the music school by 8:45 a.m. in hard padded cases; soft fabric gig bags will not be accepted on the van. During the intermission, keep oboes and clarinets swabbed dry and resting on stage stands rather than carrying them out into the cold lobby.

Best regards,
H. Kurosawa

Notice About Instrument Acclimatization for the Winter Concert — Questions

(24) Why must musicians keep their instruments inside closed cases in Room B for forty-five minutes?

1 So wooden instruments warm up gradually without cracking from sudden temperature change.

2 Because the stage lights will not be turned on until noon.

3 To hide the instruments from audience members arriving early.

4 Because tuning forks do not work in humidified rooms.

(25) What requirement applies to cellos and double basses transported in the equipment van?

1 Their strings must be removed completely before loading.

2 They must be wrapped only in soft fabric bags.

3 Players must carry them on city buses instead of the van.

4 They must be packed in hard padded cases and loaded at the music school by 8:45 a.m.

(26) What should oboe and clarinet players do with their instruments during the intermission?

1 Carry them into the cold lobby to show family members.

2 Swab them dry and leave them on stage stands.

3 Lock them inside icy car trunks.

4 Soak the wooden joints in warm water.

Why Translating Humor Across Languages Is an Art

Automated translation software has grown remarkably adept at turning weather bulletins, user manuals, and shipping contracts from one language into another within seconds. In domains where every term maps cleanly onto a fixed counterpart, literal accuracy is the highest virtue. Hand the same software a comic novel, an animated film script, or a witty newspaper column, however, and the output frequently lands with a dull thud.

Humor rarely resides in dictionary definitions alone. Puns exploit accidental collisions of sound inside a single language: an English joke built on "knight" and "night" evaporates the moment those words become two unrelated nouns in Japanese or Spanish. Comedic timing also leans heavily on grammar. Languages that place the main verb at the very end of a sentence reveal a surprise twist in a different rhythm than languages that announce action upfront. Even cultural assumptions matter—a joke about polite elevator small talk falls flat in places where riders stand in respectful silence.

Skilled literary and audiovisual translators therefore approach comedy closer to musical arrangement than word-for-word substitution. Instead of explaining a pun in an awkward footnote—which kills laughter instantly—a seasoned translator asks what emotional effect the author intended in that scene, then crafts a fresh play on words rooted in the target language's own idioms. Subtitle translators face stricter constraints still: viewers must read the line in three seconds while watching the actor's eyebrows and hearing the cadence of the original voice.

Paradoxically, departing from the literal surface is often the only way to remain faithful to a comic work's spirit. If an original line made readers chuckle at a character's pompous wordplay, a translation that is lexically exact yet lifeless betrays the text far more than an inventive local pun.

Machines may suggest vocabulary candidates quickly, yet sensing why a room laughs still demands human judgment steeped in two living cultures.

Why Translating Humor Across Languages Is an Art — Questions

(27) Why does automated translation excel with manuals and contracts yet struggle with comedy?

1 Contracts are always shorter than three sentences.

2 Translation software cannot read punctuation marks in film scripts.

3 Manuals use fixed, one-to-one terms, whereas humor relies on sound play, rhythm, and cultural context.

4 Comic novels never contain standard grammar.

(28) Why does the author mention the English words "knight" and "night" in the second paragraph?

1 To illustrate how a sound-based pun disappears when translated into languages where the words sound different.

2 To show that historical stories are easier to translate than modern news.

3 To prove that English has fewer nouns than Spanish.

4 To explain why actors whisper during night scenes.

(29) How do experienced translators usually handle an untranslatable pun in a story?

1 They delete the entire chapter from the book.

2 They create a new expression in the target language that achieves a similar comic effect.

3 They insert a two-page academic essay in the middle of the dialogue.

4 They leave the sentence in the original alphabet without translation.

(30) What extra challenge do subtitle translators face compared with book translators?

1 Viewers must read brief lines quickly while seeing the actor's expressions and hearing the original timing.

2 Subtitles are not allowed to use verbs of any kind.

3 Movie theaters ban comedies translated from foreign languages.

4 Subtitle translators never get to watch the film beforehand.

(31) What paradox about comic translation does the fourth paragraph highlight?

1 Exact word-for-word translation always produces the loudest laughter.

2 Humor can exist only in languages that place verbs at the end of sentences.

3 Readers prefer dull translations over lively ones.

4 Moving away from literal wording can be the truest way to preserve the original work's comic spirit.